

U.S. to set 15% levy on E.U. imports

Trump drops threat of 30% tariffs; specifics of agreement not yet clear

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, ELLEN FRANCIS AND DAVID J. LYNCH

EDINBURGH, SCOTLAND — President Donald Trump on Sunday touted a trade agreement with the European Union, following months of contentious negotiations with one of the United States' top trading partners.

Trump said he would impose a 15 percent duty on most imports from the European Union, about half of his latest threat of 30 percent in levies. The White House did not immediately release specific details of the trade agreement, which are traditionally hundreds of pages long and take years to negotiate.

"It's great that we made a deal today instead of playing games and maybe not making a deal at all," Trump said.

Trump and European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen announced the outlines of the deal Sunday at Trump Turnberry, one of two golf courses that the president owns in Scotland.

Both sought to paint the accord as "the biggest deal ever made," but it was unclear if they were on the same page about how steel and other critical products would be affected. The agreement is likely to become a road map for

SEE **TARIFFS** ON A7

Imaginary numbers: Trump's math doesn't always add up. **A2**



MOHAMMED SABER/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Palestinians try to grab bags of flour from an aid truck near a food distribution point in Zikim in the northern Gaza Strip on Sunday.

Trump fumes as Epstein files overshadow agenda

BY EMILY DAVIES, PERRY STEIN, JEREMY ROEBUCK AND KADIA GOBA

President Donald Trump is increasingly frustrated with how his administration's handling of the furor around the Jeffrey Epstein files has dominated the news and overshadowed his agenda, said two people familiar with his thinking.

His exasperation follows weeks of missteps and no clear strategy among top officials who underestimated the outrage, es-

Administration's plan to quell crisis dependent on public forgetting about it

pecially from the president's base, and hoped the country would forget about the unreleased Epstein files and move on, according to nearly a dozen people close to the situation, many of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity to disclose internal deliberations.

"This is a pretty substantial distraction," said one person close to the situation. "While many are trying to keep the unity, in many ways, the DOJ and the FBI are breaking at the seams. Many are wondering how sustainable this is going to be for all the parties involved — be it the FBI director or attorney general."

Despite his frustration, Trump has been hesitant to make personnel changes, according to another person close to the president: "He does not want to create a bigger spectacle by firing anyone," this person said.

At the center of the storm is Attorney General Pam Bondi, who for months made releasing the FBI's Epstein files one of her signature initiatives. Her pledge intensified the clamor among members of Trump's right-wing base to release the files amid speculation that the undisclosed evidence could implicate the financier and sex offender's rich and powerful friends.

But over the July Fourth holiday weekend, Bondi, her top deputy and FBI leaders gave final approval to an unsigned memo

SEE **EPSTEIN** ON A6

More food enters Gaza

ISRAEL ANNOUNCES 'PAUSES' IN FIGHTING

Power restored to critical water treatment plant

BY GERRY SHIH, ABBIE CHEESEMAN, LIOR SOROKA AND SIHAM SHAMALAKH

JERUSALEM — Israel on Sunday began allowing more trucks of food aid into Gaza, and it resumed supplying power to a critical water treatment plant, marking a political turnaround nearly five months after Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's government started tightly controlling the flow of humanitarian aid to pressure Hamas.

It was not immediately clear how much more aid would enter Gaza daily, but U.N. officials said Sunday that Israel appeared willing to loosen some policies at a critical juncture when the humanitarian crisis in the territory is growing more severe. Images and reports of the growing hunger crisis have drawn global condemnations of Israel and its restrictions on aid.

Scores of trucks from Egypt and Jordan set off for Gaza early Sunday, and the Israeli military said it would facilitate the movement of U.N. and other aid convoys inside the besieged territory.

SEE **GAZA** ON A11

In-demand air traffic recruits wash out of 'hostile' training

BY IAN DUNCAN

In his first few days guiding aircraft at the Oakland, California, air traffic control center, trainee Ryan Higgins deleted a plane's data from the radar screen. It was untrackable for a few frantic moments while more experienced controllers made sure the plane was on a safe path. The rookie mistake rattled Higgins and earned him a stern rebuke.

By that point, Higgins, a promising candidate with a college degree, already felt slighted by the veteran Federal Aviation Administration controllers who are responsible for training recruits under the agency's apprentice-

ship system. He witnessed another trainee get cursed out in front of his peers. He found the center's equipment outdated, with technology that he said made it difficult to understand pilots' communications. And for all the stress, the payoff — after at least three years of training — would be working in a job marked by six-day workweeks.

He quit. "I just felt kind of miserable going to work and being berated when I'm just trying to learn," said Higgins, who was 28 when he first arrived at the Oakland center, which guides thousands of passenger planes a day along busy West Coast air routes.

SEE **AIR TRAFFIC** ON A8



SERGIO FLORES/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Tim Revell moves a chair that allows his son Andrew to walk at their home in Leander, Texas.

Not giving up hope for a treatment

Family reckons with risks of gene therapy for their sons' rare disorder

BY DANIEL GILBERT

LEANDER, TEXAS — Andrew Revell leaned into his father as he pulled up from his wheelchair to stand, his legs trembling with effort. It had been more than a year since he joined a clinical trial for a gene therapy to treat the disease that is destroying his muscles and cutting short his young life. Had it made a difference? He didn't think so.

"I didn't really get the medicine," Andrew, 18, said at his

home in Texas on a recent July day.

"We don't know," Laura Revell, his mother, interjected.

"Yeah, we don't know," Andrew agreed. Doubts about whether he got the real gene therapy or a placebo in 2024 have haunted the Revell family for months. In October of this year, Andrew would get a second infusion, and if he had received the placebo the first time, he would be guaranteed to get the medicine.

But that is no longer guaran-

teed.

The deaths of two teens who received the gene therapy to treat Duchenne muscular dystrophy caused its manufacturer, Sarepta Therapeutics, to pause the clinical trial and, under pressure from regulators, halt all shipments of the drug this month. News of the deaths has rocked patients with Duchenne, a rare genetic disease that afflicts an estimated 15,000 people in the United States, the vast majority of them boys and

SEE **GENE THERAPY** ON A9



HANNAH FOSLIEN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Fan frenzy

With interest in the team reaching new heights, Commanders fans packed training camp practice in Ashburn. *More in Sports, C1*

IN THE NEWS

Tom Lehrer dies at 97 The social and political satirist subverted saccharine clichés of Cold War-era America in song. **A4**

De Minaur, Fernandez win DC Open Alex de Minaur rallies past Alejandro Davidovich Fokina for the men's tennis title; Leylah Fernandez stands atop the women's field. **C1**

THE NATION The future of Scotch whisky may rest in the hands of Donald Trump, a president who doesn't drink. **A3** **Batteries** are now king in a former West Virginia steel town. **A5**

THE WORLD Trump's visit to Scotland was marked by protests with plenty of local color. **A10** The United States is set to destroy a stockpile of contraceptives intended as foreign aid. **A11**

THE ECONOMY Experts discuss the challenges affecting the resilience of mobile homes, among the most frequent casualties of extreme weather. **A12** OpenAI's CEO missed an opportunity to stress companies' responsibility in fighting fraud, Shira Ovide writes. **A12**

STYLE Bill Camp is the ultimate character actor. And, no, he doesn't find the term insulting. **B1**

THE REGION A.D.C. crisis response team for children could shutter next year under the city's proposed budget, the program's advocates warned. **C7**

"Mermaiding" holds an escapist allure for a growing community in the D.C. area. **C7** Consumer Affairs says D.C. has the nation's worst traffic. Does it? **C7** The Montgomery County fire department is investigating three incidents involving employee behavior. **C7**

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